Incident report

Incident ID `sshbrute_demo` · generated 2026-10-18 19:41:51 UTC+04:00 by the Deception Platform

Incident: 10.10.10.10 High

Stage reached: credential access · **Confidence:** 80% · **Techniques:** T1110.001

1. Summary

10.10.10.10 opened 25 rapid SSH connections to port 2222 in 1.4 s using a libssh-based client. This matches automated SSH password guessing. No other services were touched, and the log digest was empty, so credential counts are unconfirmed.

2. Timeline

Time (local)	Event
2026-10-13 15:41:38 UTC+04:00	Capture started (first packet on the lab network)
2026-10-13 15:41:38 UTC+04:00	First packet from 10.10.10.10
2026-10-13 15:41:40 UTC+04:00	Last packet from 10.10.10.10 in this capture
2026-10-13 20:04:55 UTC+04:00	Decoy ssh_decoy appeared at 10.10.10.20:22
2026-10-18 19:29:42 UTC+04:00	Decoy ssh_decoy appeared at 10.10.10.20:22
2026-10-18 19:29:50 UTC+04:00	Decoy ssh_decoy appeared at 10.10.10.20:22

3. Attacker profile

Property	Observed (recomputed from the pcap)
Source IP	10.10.10.10
Targets	10.10.10.1
Activity window	2026-10-13 15:41:38 UTC+04:00 to 2026-10-13 15:41:40 UTC+04:00 (1 s)
Packets sent	320
New connection attempts (bare SYN)	25 to 1 distinct ports
Most probed ports	2222 (25)
HTTP requests	0
SSH client banner(s)	SSH-2.0-libssh_0.12.2
HTTP user agents	none

4. Proof

Computed from the capture and honeypot logs, independent of the analysis text above.

First packets from the attacker (raw tshark output):

```
1 0.000000000  10.10.10.10 â†’ 10.10.10.1   TCP 74 43376 2222   43376 â†’ 2222 [SYN] Seq=0 Win=64240 Len=0
MSS=1460 SACK_PERM TSval=2500029204 TSecr=0 WS=512
```

```
3 0.000372700  10.10.10.10 â†’ 10.10.10.1   TCP 66 43376 2222   43376 â†’ 2222 [ACK] Seq=1 Ack=1 Win=64512 Len=0
TSval=2500029204 TSecr=12008702
4 0.000519900  10.10.10.10 â†’ 10.10.10.1   SSH 89 43376 2222   Client: Protocol (SSH-2.0-libssh_0.12.2)
6 0.003701600  10.10.10.10 â†’ 10.10.10.1   TCP 66 43376 2222   43376 â†’ 2222 [ACK] Seq=24 Ack=641 Win=64000
Len=0 TSval=2500029208 TSecr=12008706
7 0.005099700  10.10.10.10 â†’ 10.10.10.1   SSHv2 1042 43376 2222   Client: Key Exchange Init
9 0.048305600  10.10.10.10 â†’ 10.10.10.1   SSHv2 338 43376 2222   Client: Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange Init
11 0.051691600  10.10.10.10 â†’ 10.10.10.1   SSHv2 82 43376 2222   Client: New Keys
13 0.053722000  10.10.10.10 â†’ 10.10.10.1   SSHv2 130 43376 2222   Client: Encrypted packet (len=64)
```

No honeypot session or request is attributed to this source: the capture shows connection attempts only. Honeypot logs show the Docker gateway as the source address because Docker relays published ports; the pcap is the source of truth for the attacker IP.

5. MITRE ATT&CK mapping

Technique	Name	Tactic
T1110.001	Password Guessing	Credential Access

Evidence cited by the analysis agent:

- 25 separate TCP connections to SSH port 2222 in 1.4 s
- Only one destination port targeted; all 25 connections answered
- Client banner SSH-2.0-libssh_0.12.2, consistent with automated tooling
- 571 packets in 1.43 s, about 398 packets/s

6. Response taken

Decoy	Address	Spawned	Activity
ssh_decoy	10.10.10.20:22	2026-10-13 20:04:55 UTC+04:00	18 event(s) logged on this decoy since it appeared
ssh_decoy	10.10.10.20:22	2026-10-18 19:29:42 UTC+04:00	14 event(s) logged on this decoy since it appeared
ssh_decoy	10.10.10.20:22	2026-10-18 19:29:50 UTC+04:00	8 event(s) logged on this decoy since it appeared

Blocked or declined: approval_denied ssh_decoy (operator)

Recommended decoys by the analysis: ssh_decoy. The controller only starts templates from a fixed allowlist.

7. Recommendations

- Disable password authentication for SSH (keys only), add lockout/rate limiting, and alert on repeated failed logins from one source.

8. Indicators of compromise

Type	Value
IPv4	10.10.10.10
SSH banner	SSH-2.0-libssh_0.12.2
Targeted port	2222

Evidence integrity

Capture file	SHA-256
sshbrute_full.pcap	c9ddcafe838680256c3f97ebb4eb98cf527497048badfc06aa23d5161d64aca7

Method and limits

- The analysis agent (Claude, read-only Wireshark tools) proposed these findings; the validator confirmed the schema, that the attacker IP appears in the capture, and that decoys are on the allowlist.
- Counts in sections 3 and 4 were recomputed from the capture and logs for this report.
- Captured content is attacker-controlled and is shown as escaped text only.
- Limits: lab network, a single capture window, simple attacks; confidence values are the agent's own estimate.